MKTG3112 Marketing Communications · Individual Essay

Alo in Australia – Reflection and Alternative Approach

Student number [ ]

Word count. Question One 704, Question Two 1046 (headings and body text, excluding figures, notes, prompts, references and appendices). Total 1,750

Question One – Evaluating "Mat to Moment"

1.1 Overall Assessment

Campaign effectiveness means achieving intended outcomes, not generating reach or likes (Belch & Belch, 2021). Judged against our four objectives, I believe Mat to Moment would lift store awareness (O3) but is least likely to achieve perceived worth (O1), the objective we ranked first (Appendix A). Our objectives are a strength, as each is specific, measurable and tied to a diagnosed challenge (Colley, 1961).

1.2 Target Audience

Segment A was still the right audience. Its members treat activewear as part of their identity (Belk, 1988), and the segment is reachable on Instagram and TikTok (Kemp, 2026). However, we identified a tension we never resolved. The women most drawn to Alo are also the most financially stretched (Deloitte, 2026). At A$100–200 per item, Alo is "masstige" rather than luxury, and new-luxury buyers trade up in only a few categories while trading down elsewhere (Silverstein & Fiske, 2003). We applied Kapferer and Bastien's (2009) rule that luxury needs meaning rather than justification, but I now see that a stretched buyer needs exactly that justification, because guilt suppresses indulgent purchases unless the context supplies a reason (Okada, 2005).

1.3 Message Design

Our line, "From Mat to Moment", is clear and single-minded, and its calm after-class moments are divergent in a category that shows sweat (Smith & Yang, 2004). Its weakness is distinctiveness. The line promises activewear worn from class to the rest of the day, but that is what athleisure means (Merriam-Webster, n.d.), and our own report notes that P.E Nation sells leggings the same way (P.E Nation, n.d.). Because any rival could run our line, viewers may forget it was Alo, risking our 60%

brand-attribution target. Our price argument is also weak. Most people see only bus panels and Instagram posts, where Worth it is a quick “instructor-tested” label (Petty et al., 1983) that claims quality but never explains why Alo costs A$100–200. The full case appears only on product pages, in stores and at 36 sessions reaching a few hundred people. Quick-cue attitudes are weaker and fade faster (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986), so O1, our top objective, depends on the part reaching the fewest people.

1.4 Channel Selection

Outdoor, at A$55,000 (22%), is our largest cost. Bus panels reach everyone on the route, so much of it misses young women who do Pilates (Belch & Belch, 2021). With only 43% of spend buying paid media, reaching 70% of the segment in Burst 1 is tight. Concentrating spend where the segment already is could achieve more. Ben & Jerry’s 2025 Snapchat campaign alone reached over 3 million Australians and lifted ad awareness by 13 points (Snap Inc., 2025).

1.5 Integration

Integration is our plan’s main strength. The line, set and sign-off stay fixed across every touchpoint, while only the hook and call to action adapt (Batra & Keller, 2016). However, I now see a structural inconsistency. Our objectives follow Vaughn’s (1980) feel–learn–do order, yet our journey and bursts follow AIDA, placing Attention first and the rational Worth it proof at Desire in Burst 2 (Strong, 1925). Our price argument therefore reaches only those who progress that far. About 42% of our spend also sits in high-impact, low-control activities (Duncan, as cited in Belch & Belch, 2021), with one lead creator as a single point of failure.

1.6 Likely Effectiveness and Measurement

I expect O3 to succeed, because one simple fact repeated near the stores suits peripheral learning (Petty et al., 1983). O2 is plausible, because localising Alo through Sydney sources was one of our best decisions, and localness adds relational value (Sichtmann et al., 2019). O1 is at risk, and O4 depends on it, because behaviour follows attitude (Vaughn, 1980). Our post-testing is honest but partial. Platform holdouts measure incrementality only for paid social, 21% of spend (Gordon et al., 2019), while outdoor, sessions and PR are judged on before-and-after change. With about 400 respondents, only five-point changes are reliable, so our six-point attitude targets sit near the detection limit.

1.7 What I Would Change

I would confront price openly and at scale, replace our category proposition with an ownable one, and move budget from outdoor and sessions into measurable social media. Question Two develops them.

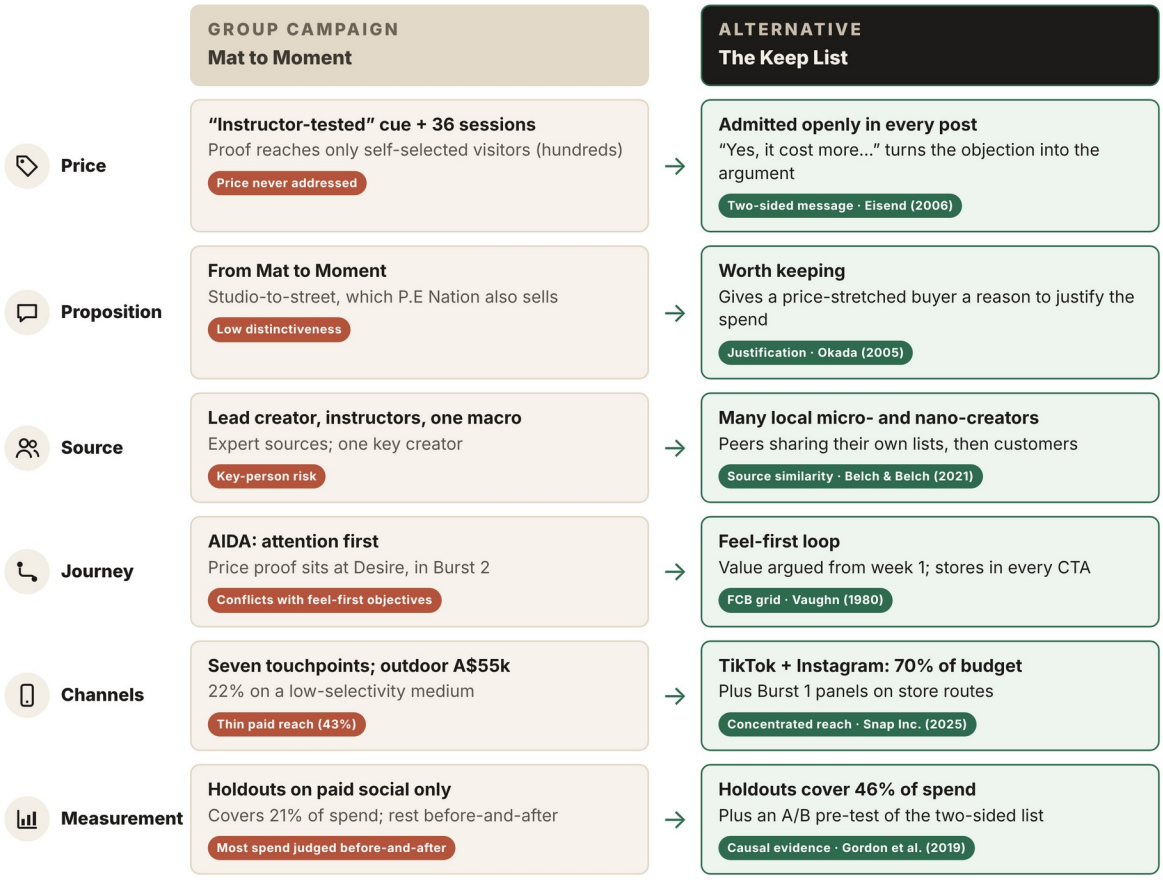
Question Two – An Alternative Approach, “The Keep List”

2.1 What I Changed and Why

The Keep List keeps Segment A, objectives O1–O4 and the A$250,000 budget, but changes the message, persuasion route, sources, journey and media mix. Each change answers a weakness from Question One (Figure 1), and O1 becomes the lead objective.

Figure 1

What Changes From the Group Campaign



Note. Weaknesses come from Question One, and tags show the main source justifying each change.

2.2 Audience and Insight

I keep Segment A, whose fit with Alo still holds (Belk, 1988; Inside Retail, 2026), but change the insight. Financial pressure makes young consumers delay major decisions (Deloitte, 2026), but they

do not cut back quietly. In 2024, “loud budgeting”, openly naming what you will not spend on, spread on TikTok as a statement of choice rather than lack (Axios, 2024). My insight is that Segment A is cutting back out loud, and what they keep says who they are. My campaign makes Alo something they keep. Alo’s positioning, premium activewear for the whole day, stays, now expressed as “worth keeping” rather than “studio to street”.

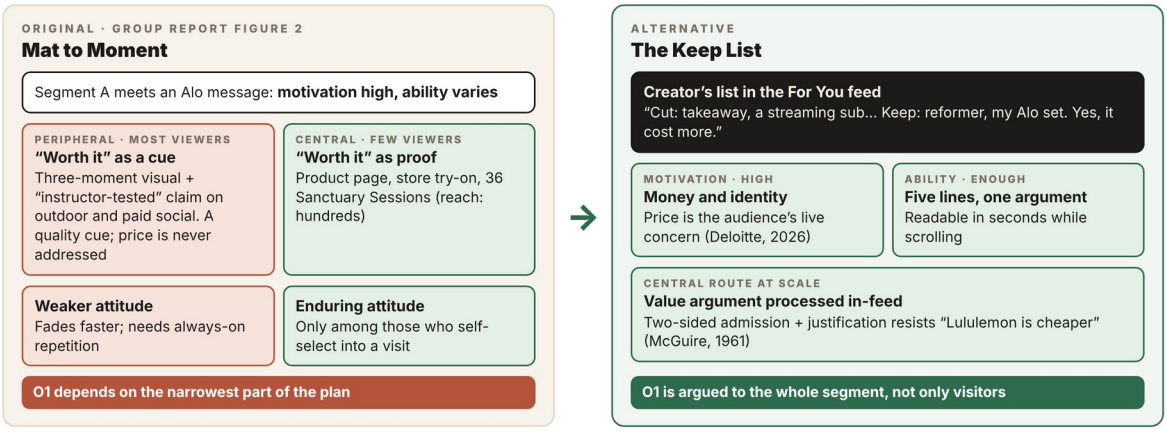
2.3 Message and Persuasion Route

Our original message was one-sided. Mine is two-sided, as creators admit that Alo costs more, then explain why it is worth keeping. Peers, not Alo, discuss price, protecting prestige (Kapferer & Bastien, 2009). Two-sided messages increase source credibility (Eisend, 2006), and refuting an objection in advance protects against counter-arguments (McGuire, 1961) such as “Lululemon is cheaper”. The list also supplies the justification our campaign lacked (Okada, 2005). Under mental accounting, consumers assign spending to separate budgets (Thaler, 1999), so setting Alo beside cancelled takeaway moves it from “fashion splurge” to “things I use every day” (Appendix B). It remains a rational value appeal, without discounts (Mela et al., 1997).

In our plan (Figure 2), central processing of price required a visit. A five-line list is read in seconds yet carries one argument, so motivated viewers can process it centrally while scrolling (Petty et al., 1983). O1 is therefore argued to the whole segment, not only to visitors.

Figure 2

Elaboration Likelihood Model, Before and After



Note. Adapted from Petty et al. (1983) and the group report’s Figure 2.

2.4 Sources

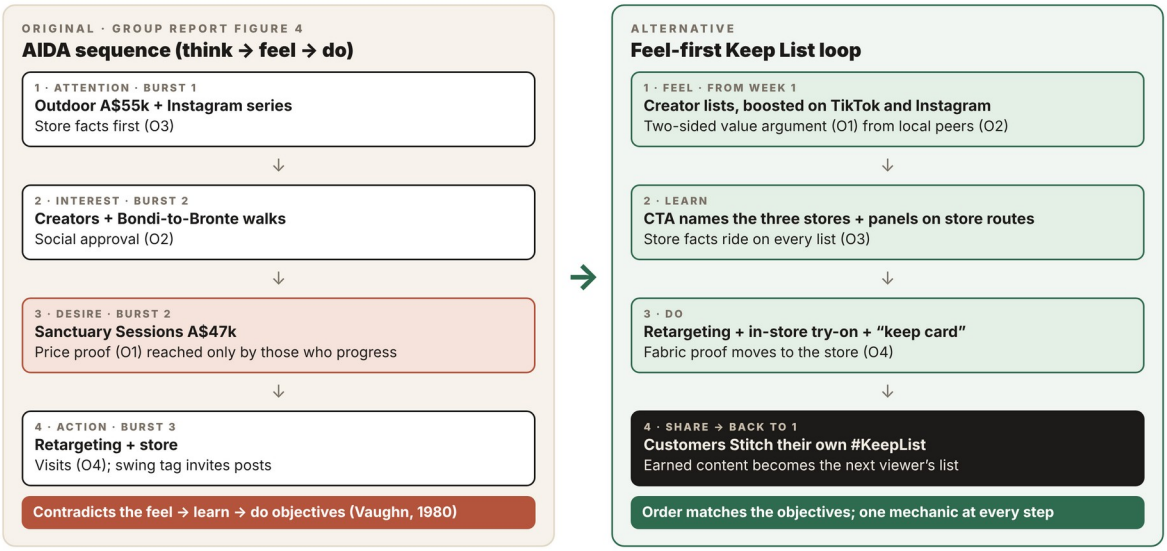
I replace our lead and macro creators with many Sydney micro- and nano-creators, then customers. Smaller creators achieve higher engagement and closer trust (Campbell & Farrell, 2020), and similarity to the audience is part of source attractiveness (Belch & Belch, 2021). This also removes our single point of failure. Customer-made TikTok content for frank green shows the model working (TikTok for Business, n.d.). “Keep List” is an ownable mechanic rather than a category benefit, so it should be easier to attribute to Alo (Sharp, 2010).

2.5 Journey, Channels and Budget

Figure 3 replaces our AIDA sequence with a feel-first loop matching Vaughn’s (1980) order. Lists build attitude (O1, O2), every call to action names the stores (O3), retargeting and in-store try-ons drive visits (O4), and customers’ Stitches feed the next viewer (Court et al., 2009). Creator posts are boosted as paid ads, so paid, owned and earned media carry the same content (Stephen & Galak, 2012). With a “keep card” in store and consented customer lists on Burst 3 posters, one mechanic runs through every touchpoint. I retain pulsing but lead Burst 1 with lists (Appendix C).

Figure 3

Consumer Journey, Before and After

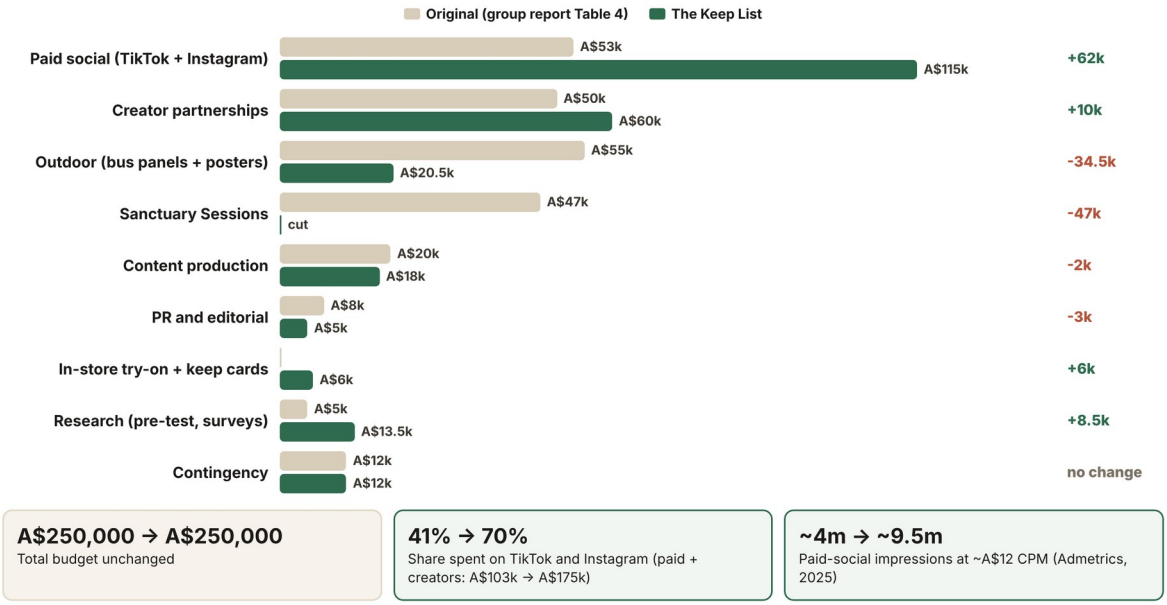


Note. Adapted from Strong (1925), Vaughn (1980), Court et al. (2009) and the group report’s Figure 4.

Figure 4 shows my budget, which stays at A$250,000. I cut Sanctuary Sessions (A$47,000) because their proof reached hundreds, and reduce outdoor from A$55,000 to A$20,500 for Burst 1 panels on store routes. TikTok and Instagram rise from A$103,000 to A$175,000, 70% of the budget. At about A$12 per thousand impressions (Admetrics, 2025), A$115,000 of paid social buys roughly 9.5 million impressions, more than double our original four million.

Figure 4

Budget Reallocation Within A$250,000

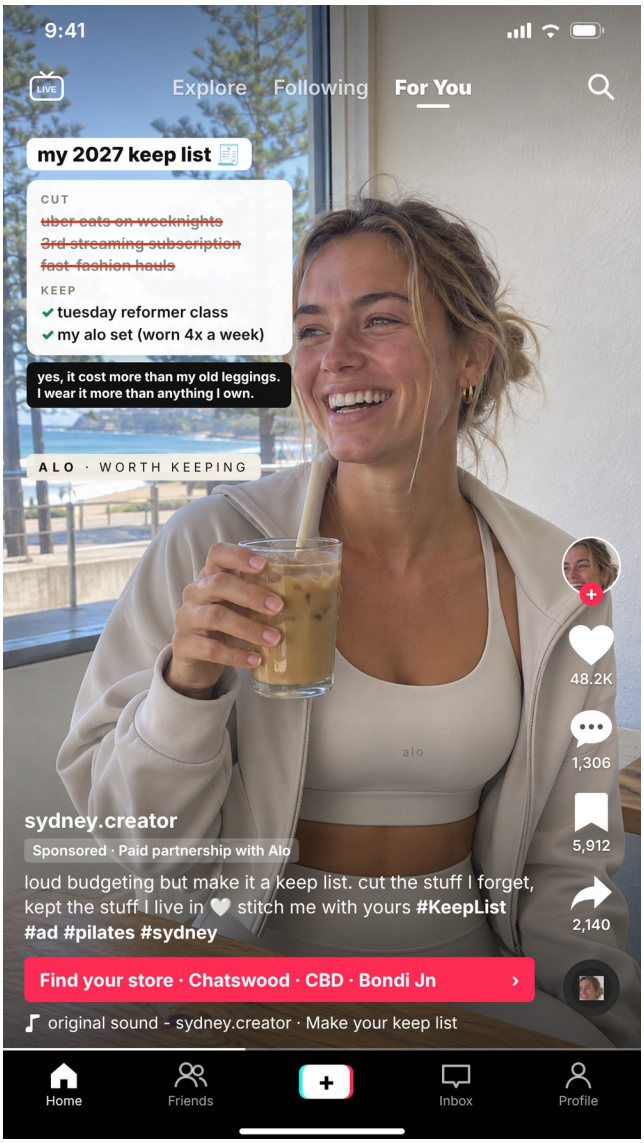


Note. Original figures are from the group report's Table 4. Bus panels cover 20 panels for three weeks at GoTransit (n.d.) rates plus production, with A$4,000 for posters. Creators cover about 100 micro and nano posts at A$150–750 each (Wise, 2025).

2.6 Creative Mock-up

Figure 5

“The Keep List” TikTok In-Feed Creator Post (Burst 1)



Note. AI-generated photograph composed into a TikTok frame. The person is not real, and the handle and engagement figures are illustrative. AI prompts used. (1) Photograph, generated with [name the image tool you used], using the prompt “Photorealistic vertical 9:16 smartphone photo that looks like a still from an iPhone TikTok video, not a professional shoot. A woman in her mid-twenties sits at a small timber table by the window of a casual café in Bondi, Sydney, around 9am, just after a reformer Pilates class. She wears a matching Alo Yoga–style set: a sleek, smooth sculpting sports bra and high-waisted leggings with a subtle sheen, in a soft neutral ‘bone’ colour, with an oversized cropped zip jacket in the same colour open over it. Clean, minimal, premium design. Do not render any text or logos on the clothing. Natural, unretouched skin, minimal makeup, hair in a slightly messy low bun, small gold hoop earrings. She is laughing naturally while holding an iced oat latte and looking just off camera. Soft morning sunlight comes through the window, with the ocean and Norfolk pines faintly visible and out of focus behind her. Handheld phone-camera look: slight

grain, true-to-life colour, shallow depth of field. Composition: she sits in the right half of the frame, shown from the waist up, with her face about 45% of the way down the image. Keep the upper-left third and the bottom quarter visually quiet so text overlays can sit there. No text, logos, watermarks or other people in focus." (2) TikTok frame, composed with Claude (Anthropic), using the prompt "Place this photo in an accurate TikTok For You in-feed Spark Ad frame (1080 × 1920 px) with the status bar, LIVE/Explore/Following/For You tabs, right-hand rail (creator avatar with follow button, likes, comments, saves, shares, sound disc), 'Sponsored · Paid partnership with Alo' under the handle, the caption with #KeepList and #ad, a red call-to-action button 'Find your store · Chatswood · CBD · Bondi Jn' and the sound line. Add native TikTok text overlays in the empty window area: 'my 2027 keep list', a Notes-style list (CUT: uber eats on weeknights; 3rd streaming subscription; fast-fashion hauls, struck through; KEEP: tuesday reformer class; my alo set (worn 4x a week)), the aside 'yes, it cost more than my old leggings. I wear it more than anything I own.' and an 'ALO · WORTH KEEPING' sticker. Add a small, correctly spelled 'alo' wordmark on the sports bra. Keep every overlay clear of her face."

Media format. Figure 5 is the opening frame of a 15-second TikTok Spark Ad, a creator's post boosted as paid media. The list builds line by line beneath her voice-over, ending on the store call to action.

Message. The list is the argument, with three things cut, two kept, then the admission "yes, it cost more than my old leggings". The sign-off "Alo. Worth keeping." attaches the justification to the brand. It persuades because it argues value in the audience's terms, not the brand's.

Imagery. A woman in her mid-twenties laughs over an iced latte in a beachside Sydney café after class, wearing the matching set. Natural light, unretouched skin and a handheld look suit Gen Z's preference for authenticity (Francis & Hoefel, 2018), making the endorsement believable, while the local setting supports O2.

Design. Native TikTok text makes the post read as creator content, while Alo's neutral palette, wordmark and sticker preserve brand linkage. "Sponsored · Paid partnership" sits under the handle and #ad in the caption, because advertising must be clearly distinguishable, especially in native formats (Australian Association of National Advertisers [AANA], 2021; Wojdynski & Evans, 2016).

Call to action and engagement. "Find your store" names Chatswood, the CBD and Bondi Junction (O3, O4), while the caption invites viewers to Stitch their own list, turning viewers into sources.

AI limitations. My AI-generated photograph is believable but too polished for phone footage, and audiences tend to see artificial personas as uncanny and "authentically fake" (Lou et al., 2023). The tool also cannot reproduce Alo's garments or logo, so I added the wordmark afterwards. In execution, real creators must wear real Alo and list genuine trade-offs, because scripted claims presented as personal experience would be misleading (Competition and Consumer Act 2010 (Cth) sch 2 s 18).

2.7 Measurement

I would pre-test the two-sided list against a one-sided version on brand attribution and “worth paying more for” (Belch & Belch, 2021). In post-testing, platform brand-lift holdouts would measure incrementality across 46% of spend rather than our 21% (Gordon et al., 2019; Appendix D).

2.8 Advantages, Limitations and Expected Effectiveness

Compared with our original, The Keep List argues price to the whole segment, gives an ownable proposition and doubles paid reach within the same budget. I see three limitations. First, financial hardship is a recognised source of consumer vulnerability (Australian Competition and Consumer Commission [ACCC], 2021), and manipulation undermines normal decision-making (Sher, 2011), so lists must celebrate what people cut and never present the set as a necessity. Second, loud budgeting peaked in 2024, so I use “Keep List”, not the trend’s name. Third, cutting sessions and walks loses hands-on proof and editorial coverage, which in-store try-ons only partly replace. Overall, I expect stronger O1, similar O3 and store-dependent O4 results.

References

Admetrics. (2025). Instagram ads costs: Complete 2025 pricing guide. https://admetrics.io/en/post/instagram-ads-costs-complete-2025-pricing-guide

Australian Association of National Advertisers. (2021). AANA code of ethics. https://aana.com.au/self-regulation/codes-guidelines/code-of-ethics/

Australian Competition and Consumer Commission. (2021, November). Consumer vulnerability: A business guide to the Australian Consumer Law. https://consumeraffairs.nt.gov.au/_resources/documents/for-businesses/acl-guides/consumer-vulnerability.pdf

Australian Competition and Consumer Commission. (2023, December). Scrutiny of influencers and businesses for misleading advertising and online reviews continues [Media release]. https://www.accc.gov.au/media-release/scrutiny-of-influencers-and-businesses-for-misleading-advertising-and-online-reviews-continues

Axios. (2024, February 2). Gen Z fuels “loud budgeting” personal finance trend. https://www.axios.com/2024/02/02/loud-budgeting-personal-finance-trend-gen-z

Batra, R., & Keller, K. L. (2016). Integrating marketing communications: New findings, new lessons, and new ideas. Journal of Marketing, 80(6), 122–145. https://doi.org/10.1509/jm.15.0419

Belch, G. E., & Belch, M. A. (2021). Advertising and promotion: An integrated marketing communications perspective (12th ed.). McGraw-Hill Education.

Belk, R. W. (1988). Possessions and the extended self. Journal of Consumer Research, 15(2), 139–168. https://doi.org/10.1086/209154

Campbell, C., & Farrell, J. R. (2020). More than meets the eye: The functional components underlying influencer marketing. Business Horizons, 63(4), 469–479. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bushor.2020.03.003

Colley, R. H. (1961). Defining advertising goals for measured advertising results. Association of National Advertisers.

Competition and Consumer Act 2010 (Cth). https://www.legislation.gov.au/C2004A00109/latest/text

Court, D., Elzinga, D., Mulder, S., & Vetvik, O. J. (2009). The consumer decision journey. McKinsey Quarterly, (3), 96–107.

Deloitte. (2026). 2026 Gen Z and millennial survey. https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/issues/work/genz-millennial-survey.html

Eisend, M. (2006). Two-sided advertising: A meta-analysis. International Journal of Research in Marketing, 23(2), 187–198. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijresmar.2005.11.001

Francis, T., & Hoefel, F. (2018, November 12). 'True Gen': Generation Z and its implications for companies. McKinsey & Company. https://www.mckinsey.com/industries/consumer-packaged-goods/our-insights/true-gen-generation-z-and-its-implications-for-companies

Gordon, B. R., Zettelmeyer, F., Bhargava, N., & Chapsky, D. (2019). A comparison of approaches to advertising measurement: Evidence from big field experiments at Facebook. Marketing Science, 38(2), 193–225. https://doi.org/10.1287/mksc.2018.1135

GoTransit. (n.d.). Bus advertising. Retrieved October 28, 2026, from https://gotransit.com.au/

Inside Retail. (2026, May). Alo makes Australian debut at Sydney's Chatswood Chase. https://insideretail.com.au/stores/openings-closings/alo-makes-australian-debut-at-sydneys-chatswood-chase-202605

Kapferer, J.-N., & Bastien, V. (2009). The luxury strategy: Break the rules of marketing to build luxury brands. Kogan Page.

Keller, K. L. (2001). Mastering the marketing communications mix: Micro and macro perspectives on integrated marketing communication programs. Journal of Marketing Management, 17(7–8), 819–847. https://doi.org/10.1362/026725701323366836

Kemp, S. (2026). Digital 2026: Australia. DataReportal. https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2026-australia

Lou, C., Kiew, S. T. J., Chen, T., Lee, T. Y. M., Ong, J. E. C., & Phua, Z. (2023). Authentically fake? How consumers respond to the influence of virtual influencers. Journal of Advertising, 52(4), 540–557.

McGuire, W. J. (1961). The effectiveness of supportive and refutational defenses in immunizing and restoring beliefs against persuasion. Sociometry, 24(2), 184–197. https://doi.org/10.2307/2786067

Mela, C. F., Gupta, S., & Lehmann, D. R. (1997). The long-term impact of promotion and advertising on consumer brand choice. Journal of Marketing Research, 34(2), 248–261. https://doi.org/10.1177/002224379703400205

Merriam-Webster. (n.d.). Athleisure. In Merriam-Webster.com dictionary. Retrieved November 1, 2026, from https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/athleisure

Okada, E. M. (2005). Justification effects on consumer choice of hedonic and utilitarian goods. Journal of Marketing Research, 42(1), 43–53. https://doi.org/10.1509/jmkr.42.1.43.56889

P.E Nation. (n.d.). Dynamic full length legging in major brown. Retrieved November 8, 2026, from https://www.pe-nation.com/products/dynamic-full-length-legging-in-major-brown

Petty, R. E., & Cacioppo, J. T. (1986). The elaboration likelihood model of persuasion. Advances in Experimental Social Psychology, 19, 123–205. https://doi.org/10.1016/S0065-2601(08)60214-2

Petty, R. E., Cacioppo, J. T., & Schumann, D. (1983). Central and peripheral routes to advertising effectiveness: The moderating role of involvement. Journal of Consumer Research, 10(2), 135–146. https://doi.org/10.1086/208954

Sharp, B. (2010). How brands grow: What marketers don’t know. Oxford University Press.

Sher, S. (2011). A framework for assessing immorally manipulative marketing tactics. Journal of Business Ethics, 102(1), 97–118. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-011-0802-4

Sichtmann, C., Davvetas, V., & Diamantopoulos, A. (2019). The relational value of perceived brand globalness and localness. Journal of Business Research, 104, 597–613. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2018.10.025

Silverstein, M. J., & Fiske, N. (2003). Luxury for the masses. Harvard Business Review, 81(4), 48–57.

Smith, R. E., & Yang, X. (2004). Toward a general theory of creativity in advertising: Examining the role of divergence. Marketing Theory, 4(1–2), 31–58. https://doi.org/10.1177/1470593104044086

Snap Inc. (2025). Ben & Jerry's success story. Snapchat for Business. https://forbusiness.snapchat.com/inspiration/ben-and-jerry-success-story

Stephen, A. T., & Galak, J. (2012). The effects of traditional and social earned media on sales: A study of a microlending marketplace. Journal of Marketing Research, 49(5), 624–639. https://doi.org/10.1509/jmr.09.0401

Strong, E. K., Jr. (1925). The psychology of selling and advertising. McGraw-Hill.

Thaler, R. H. (1999). Mental accounting matters. Journal of Behavioral Decision Making, 12(3), 183–206. https://doi.org/10.1002/(SICI)1099-0771(199909)12:3<183::AID-BDM318>3.0.CO;2-F

TikTok for Business. (n.d.). frank green [Success story]. Retrieved November 1, 2026, from https://ads.tiktok.com/business/en/inspiration/frank-green

Vaughn, R. (1980). How advertising works: A planning model. Journal of Advertising Research, 20(5), 27–33.

Wise. (2025). Influencer marketing in 2025: Complete guide for Australian businesses. https://wise.com/au/blog/influencer-marketing

Wojdynski, B. W., & Evans, N. J. (2016). Going native: Effects of disclosure position and language on the recognition and evaluation of online native advertising. Journal of Advertising, 45(2), 157–168. https://doi.org/10.1080/00913367.2015.1115380

Appendix A

Figure A1

Evaluation of "Mat to Moment" Against Its Objectives

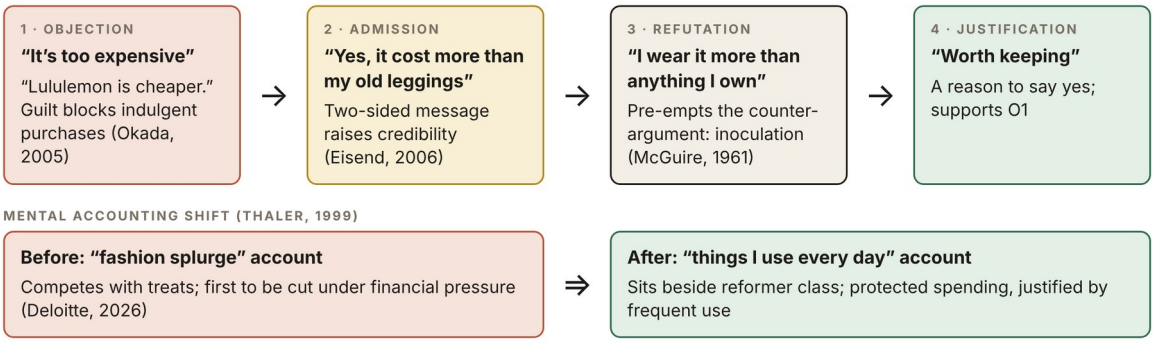
Objective	Main mechanism in the group plan	Evaluation	Likely outcome
O3 Learn: aware of Sydney stores (25% → 35%)	Store names on outdoor (A$55k) and the Instagram series in Burst 1	A simple fact suits peripheral learning (Petty et al., 1983); repetition builds memory (Keller, 2001)	Likely Strongest objective
O2 Feel: "a brand for people like me in Sydney" (12% → 18%)	Sydney instructors, creators and settings re-encode the LA brand	Localness adds relational value (Sichtmann et al., 2019); target sits near the ~5-point survey limit	Possible
O1 Feel: "worth paying more for" (15% → 21%)	"Instructor-tested" cue on reach media; proof in sessions, product pages and stores	Cue never addresses price; central route reaches self-selected visitors only (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986); guilt unaddressed (Okada, 2005)	At risk Top priority, weakest mechanism
O4 Do: visited store or site (8% → 11%)	Retargeting, session bookings, store CTAs	Behaviour follows attitude (Vaughn, 1980), so depends on O1	Uncertain

Note. My evaluation, supporting Question One.

Appendix B

Figure B1

Two-Sided Message Structure, Inoculation and Mental Accounting

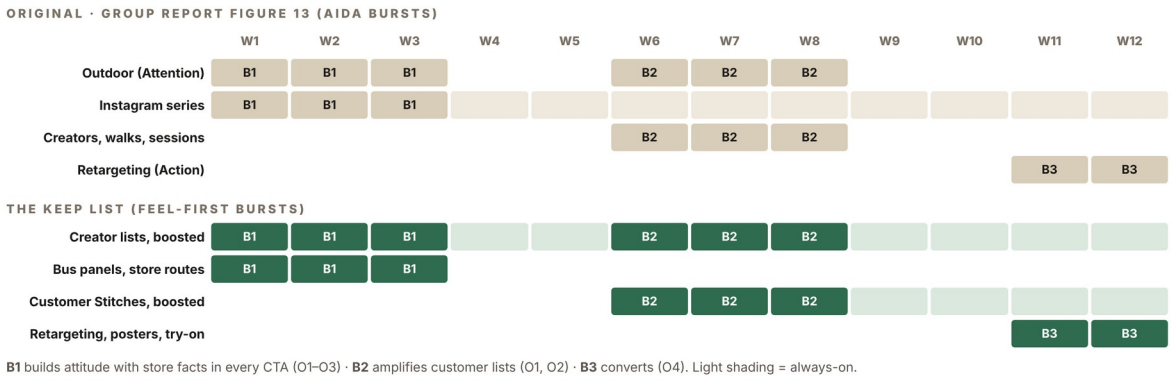


Note. Adapted from Eisend (2006), McGuire (1961), Okada (2005) and Thaler (1999).

Appendix C

Figure C1

Pulsing Schedule, Before and After



Note. Adapted from the group report's Figure 13, with pulsing from Belch and Belch (2021).

Appendix D

Figure D1

Pre-Testing, In-Flight and Post-Testing Plan



Pre- and post-testing stages from Belch and Belch (2021); randomised holdout rationale from Gordon et al. (2019).

Note. Adapted from Belch and Belch (2021) and Gordon et al. (2019).